

commUni

Business Case Study

KEY RESOURCES · CHANNELS · RELATIONSHIPS · REVENUE · COSTS

Agenda

01

Key Resources

What we need to build and run the app

02

Channels

How students find out about commUni

03

Community Relationships

How we keep students engaged and safe

04

Revenue Streams

How commUni earns money

05

Cost Structure

What it costs to launch and operate

What we need to *make it work*

1

Technology

Tech we need to run our app

- The app and its software
- Servers & cloud storage
- Search & matching features
- Data protection & security

2

People

Skills to develop & manage the app

- App developers
- UI / UX designers
- Marketing & social media specialists
- Knowledge of students' needs

3

Community

Our users and the content they share

- Active students from different universities
- Shared study notes & learning materials
- Shared-flat (WG) listings & housing profiles

4

Brand Identity

What makes us recognisable

- App name & logo
- Unique app features & design

Network effect: more users mean more content and more connections – the community is our most valuable resource.

5 · Financial resources: funding for development, launch and the first years of operation – see *Cost Structure*.

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Social media: *where students already are*

Youth channels – ranked by priority

Ads and influencer content on

1	TikTok	Influencers who happen to be students
2	Pinterest	Aesthetic study & living inspiration
3	Instagram	Influencers who happen to be students

“Student influencers show commUni as part of their daily life.”

They use it to structure, optimise and simplify their days at university – in the most aesthetic way possible.

Campus, word of mouth *& web*

U

Universities

Direct access to new students

- Cooperation with universities
- App is introduced during welcome weeks
- Posters on campus and ads on university websites

S

Students themselves

Word of mouth & referrals

- Students tell their friends and family
- Little treats, e.g. a free event ticket for shared welcome links and registrations

W

Websites

First point of contact online

- App Store & Google Play listing
- Our own website to give a first insight

Five ways we *build loyalty*

For commUni it is important to build a strong relationship with our users and keep them interested in the app.

1

Community exchange & networking

Students connect with others who share similar interests – e.g. study groups or sports clubs.

2

Personalised recommendations

Every student has different needs, so we show relevant content: shared flats, second-hand furniture, tutoring offers.

3

Digital service & feedback

Users get help directly in the app and give feedback that helps us improve commUni.

4

Trust & safety

Moderation keeps the platform safe – especially when students look for flats or trade items with strangers.

5

User loyalty

Relevant content, regular updates and helpful reminders keep students coming back.

We want our users to feel *connected*, *understood* and *safe*.

This helps us build long-term relationships with our community.

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How commUni *earns money*

1

Ads & sponsored posts

Brands pay us to show student-specific ads in our app.

Fashion · Lifestyle · Fitness · Cafés & stores

2

Sponsored placement

People who offer their flat or products can pay to be seen by more users.

3

Events & meet-ups

Revenue from events and community meetings.

5 € per person

4

Paid cooperations

Partnerships with universities and student-lifestyle brands.

5

Commission

Earned through partner links and successful sales.

Free for students – financed by brands, partners and the community.

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One-time costs: *building & launching*

1

Development & Design

Complex app
≈ 1,600 hrs development time × 100 €/h

≈ 160k €

Largest single cost item

2

Founding

GmbH formation	≈ 1k €
Share capital (equity)	25k €
GDPR / data protection	≈ 2k €

Share capital is equity, not an expense.

3

Branding & Launch

Logo & branding	500 – 3,000 €
Google Play Store	25 € once
Apple App Store	99 € / year
Website launch	incl.

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Running costs: *operating the app*

Hosting & Maintenance

Hosting ~10,000 users at start	50 – 200 € / month
Maintenance 15–20 % of dev. cost	24 – 32k €

Marketing

Cost per install (CPI)	5 – 8.50 €
10,000 downloads	< 85k €

Personnel

Median manager 3.2k € gross + 20 % employer share	≈ 50k € / year
Working students for services	15 – 18 € / hour

Tools & Fees

Tools Figma, Adobe, Claude …	300 – 1,000 €
Store commission Google & Apple, revenue < 1m €/yr	15 %

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Total cost *at a glance*

YEAR 1 · BUILD & LAUNCH

135 – 300k €

Development, founding, branding, initial marketing, personnel and running costs.

YEAR 2 · OPERATE & GROW

80 – 120k €

No more one-time development costs – mainly maintenance, hosting, marketing and personnel.



Thank *you*

Questions & discussion

comm*Uni*